Inaayat — Business Model, Pricing & Compliance Guide

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1. Snapshot

Inaayat is a two-sided marketplace: donors give to verified NGOs, and Inaayat earns a small, transparent fee on general donations (not on Zakat) plus paid tools for NGOs later. The safest starting model is a per-donation fee of about 5% all-in, no listing fee, and 0% deducted from Zakat.

Simple matlab: pehle donors aur NGOs ko jama karo, phir kamao. Shuru mein NGO se listing fee mat lo, kyunke naye platform par NGO ko pehle koi value nazar nahi aati.

Who pays	Who receives	What for	Phase
Donor	NGO	The donation itself	1
NGO (deducted from donation)	Inaayat	Platform fee, about 5% all-in on general donations	1
Donor (optional)	Inaayat	Tip, or "cover the fees" at checkout	1
NGO	Inaayat	Monthly Pro/Premium plan (lower fee, analytics, featured slots)	2
Companies	Inaayat	CSR reporting package	3
Donor	Inaayat	Optional Inaayat Plus	3

Figures in this guide are starting hypotheses to test, not proven prices. Legal and tax points are a general guide: confirm them with a lawyer and a tax consultant before launch.

2. Value proposition: why will they use Inaayat?

Both sides join only if Inaayat saves them effort or risk. The proposal's edge is one place for many NGOs, local wallets, Zakat and Sadqa tools, Urdu and English, and NGO analytics. Competitors each cover only one NGO, one cause or one payment step.

Donors

Their problem today	What Inaayat gives
Cannot tell which NGO is real	Manual verification and a "Verified by Inaayat" badge with an expiry date
Manual bank transfers, scattered websites	One app, JazzCash and Easypaisa, three taps to donate
No proof or follow-up	Instant receipt, donation history, Sadqa Jariya progress updates
Zakat is confusing	Zakat calculator linked straight to donating
Wants to ask questions	Direct chat with NGO representatives, plus bilingual chatbot

NGOs

Their problem today	What Inaayat gives
Few online donors, no payment setup	Reach to the donor base and wallet payments without building their own system
Receipts and records done by hand	Automatic receipts and donor records
No data on who gives and when	Dashboard, donor segments, re-engagement list
Writing updates takes time	Impact story generator, with NGO review before publishing
Low donor trust	Verified badge plus transparent reporting

The honest test: an NGO should be able to say "I get more money with Inaayat than on my own website". Until that is true, do not charge NGOs a fixed fee.

3. Revenue model and starting percentages

Start with a transparent per-donation fee of about 5% all-in on general donations, and 0% on Zakat. Add NGO subscriptions and paid featuring only after NGOs see results. 10% is too high for a new platform: NGOs will keep using their own channels.

Option	Verdict	Why
Per-donation fee	**Use first**	NGOs pay only when they receive money; no upfront risk
5-10% "listing commission"	Use 5% at most	Above 5% NGOs will refuse; 10% only for optional paid marketing campaigns
Monthly fee for NGOs	Phase 2	Charge once Pro tools (analytics, donor CRM) clearly pay for themselves
Paid "top of list" ranking	Limited, labelled	Only as clearly marked "Featured" slots for verified NGOs; never reorder the main list by payment, or donor trust drops
Donor tip / "cover the fees"	**Use first**	Lets the NGO receive 100% and gives Inaayat income without cutting the donation
CSR packages	Phase 3	Companies need reporting and tax-ready receipts

Suggested fee table (to test, not fixed)

Donation type	Platform fee	Note
General donation / Sadqa / campaign	5% all-in	Covers gateway cost (roughly 1.5-3%, approximate: confirm with JazzCash/Easypaisa)
Recurring monthly	4%	Reward for predictable income
Emergency relief	2-3%	Goodwill, drives volume and trust
Zakat	0% deducted	See next section

Worked example (illustrative): donor gives Rs 10,000. NGO receives Rs 9,500. Gateway takes about Rs 200. Inaayat keeps about Rs 300. If the donor ticks "cover the fees", the NGO receives the full Rs 10,000.

Zakat rule. Taking a cut from Zakat is a religious-ruling question, because Zakat must reach eligible recipients. Safest: deduct nothing from Zakat, and fund costs from tips, general donations, NGO subscriptions and sponsors. Get a written opinion from a Shariah

scholar before launch.

Costs to budget (get real quotes): AWS hosting, OpenAI API usage, SendGrid emails, gateway fees, verification staff time, customer support, legal and accounting. Break-even volume = monthly costs divided by the net fee kept per rupee donated.

Simple matlab: pehle 5% all-in rakho, Zakat par 0%, aur donor ko tip ka option do. Percentage baad mein data dekh kar badlein.

4. Packages and subscriptions

Keep Phase 1 simple: a free NGO tier and a free donor app. Introduce paid plans in Phase 2. Prices below are placeholders to test with 5-10 real NGOs.

NGO plans

	Starter (free)	Pro (placeholder Rs 4,999/month)	Premium (placeholder Rs 14,999/month)
Platform fee	5%	3.5%	2.5%
Campaigns	Up to 3	Unlimited	Unlimited
Profile and verified badge	Yes	Yes	Yes
Auto receipts and donor list	Basic	Full donor CRM and segments	Full
Analytics and predictive donor list	No	Yes	Yes plus exports
AI impact story generator and staff chatbot	Limited	Yes	Yes
"Featured" slot (labelled)	No	1 slot per month	Priority slots
Support	Email	Priority email	Named contact

Donor plans

	Free	Inaayat Plus (optional, later)	Corporate / CSR
Donate, receipts, history, Zakat calculator	Yes	Yes	Yes
Recurring giving	Yes	Yes	Yes
Yearly giving and tax summary	Basic	Detailed	Company-wide report
Impact reports from NGOs	Basic	Detailed	Audit-ready
Bulk donations and team giving	No	No	Yes
Price	Free	Small monthly fee (to test)	Custom

Donors should never be charged to give. Plus should only sell extras (reports, convenience), and the Corporate plan is where donor-side revenue is most realistic.

For the FYP evaluation: show the free tiers and the fee logic working. Mention paid plans as future scope.

5. Funds flow, hold-and-release and NGO verification

Hold large or risky donations until a human checks them, but do the holding through a licensed payment partner, never in a personal or ordinary business account. Only NGOs with current, checkable approvals are listed.

Funds flow (target design)

1. Donor pays through JazzCash or Easypaisa into the payment partner's settlement account.
2. Inaayat records the donation and runs the risk rules.
3. Normal donation: settled to the NGO's bank account in its own name, minus the fee.
4. Flagged donation: status "On hold", reviewed by an admin, then released or refunded.
5. Donor and NGO both see the status and get a receipt after release.

Whether Inaayat may hold money itself depends on its payment licence and the gateway's merchant terms. Ask the gateway and a lawyer before promising holds in the real product. In the FYP, simulate it with a status field.

Hold triggers (proposed defaults, adjustable by admin)

Trigger	Example default	Action
Single large donation	Above Rs 100,000	Hold, admin review
Daily total from one donor	Above Rs 250,000	Hold, review
New donor account plus large amount	Account under 48 hours old	Hold
Many rapid payments from one source	5 or more in 10 minutes	Hold, flag
New NGO	First 30 days	Delay release by 3-5 working days
Sudden pattern change	Far above donor's usual amount	Flag

Target release: within 3-5 working days after review. Show the donor and the NGO the reason and the expected time.

NGO verification (manual, per the proposal)

Check	Source
Legal registration	SECP licence (Section 42 company), or trust or society registration, or provincial Charities Commission registration
Tax approval	FBR approval as a non-profit under Section 2(36), which is what makes donor tax credits possible. Certificates are time-limited (often 3 years), so record the expiry
PCP certification	Optional trust badge; the Pakistan Centre for Philanthropy certifies NGOs
Bank account	Account in the NGO's own name; a cancelled cheque or statement
People	CNIC of CEO and directors; confirm they are not on a proscribed or sanctions list

Check	Source
Reality check	Video call, address check, past reports; site visit for large NGOs

Workflow: submit documents, admin checks each item, cross-checks the public registries, approves with an expiry date, re-verifies yearly or when any certificate expires, and can suspend instantly after complaints.

6. Maslak (sect) policy

Use one neutral platform, organised by cause (health, education, relief), not by sect. Splitting by maslak shrinks the donor base, raises sectarian-content and reputation risk, and makes every NGO look affiliated with a camp. Serve different fiqh needs through optional filters instead.

Decision	Recommendation
Separate apps or sections per maslak (Sunni, Deobandi, Ahle Hadith, Shia, etc.)	No. One platform, one verification standard for everyone
Public maslak label on each NGO	No by default. Optional self-declared "fiqh / school of thought" field the NGO controls
Donor preference	Optional filter, for example "show NGOs that follow my fiqh for Zakat"
Shia-specific giving (Khums, share of the Imam)	Offer as an optional category with NGOs that collect it, kept separate from general funds
Zakat eligibility rules	A Shariah advisory board with scholars from more than one school; document which fiqh each Zakat NGO follows
Sectarian content	Banned in campaigns, chat and profiles; report and suspend
Safety screening	Screen every NGO and director against the government's proscribed organisations list; reject any match, regardless of maslak

Why this works: a donor chooses by need (flood relief, orphan care), and a donor with a fiqh requirement can narrow the list. The NGO is never forced to wear a label.

Different Zakat rules (nisab, eligible categories, who may receive) differ between schools. Keep the calculator configurable: default to a standard method, and let the user pick their fiqh.

Simple matlab: ek hi platform, kaam ke hisaab se categories, maslak sirf optional filter ke taur par. Aur kisi bhi banned ya proscribed tanzeem ko list nahi karna.

7. Legal, tax and compliance checklist (beginner owner)

This is a general guide based on public sources found on 20 October 2026, not legal or tax advice. Hire a lawyer and a chartered accountant before collecting real money.

Before launch

Area	What to know	Action
Business structure	Inaayat as a for-profit company earning fees is different from a non-profit. A Section 42 non-profit cannot distribute profit; a for-profit platform must disclose its fees clearly	Ask a lawyer which structure fits; a private limited company is common when handling payments
Registration and tax numbers	Payment merchant accounts normally ask for CNIC, business registration, NTN and a bank account (source)	Register the business, get NTN, open a business bank account
Payment accounts	JazzCash needs a verified merchant account in your own name; sandbox accounts are free for testing (source)	Use sandbox for the FYP; apply for live accounts only after registration
Income tax and sales tax on your fee	Your commission is business income, and service fees may attract provincial sales tax on services	Ask an accountant which province's tax applies and how to register

Area	What to know	Action
Donor tax credit (Section 61)	Donors get a tax credit for donations to non-profits approved under Section 2(36) (PCP guide). Cap shown on approved NGOs' pages is 30% of taxable income for individuals, 20% for companies (example)	List NGOs with valid approval; show the approval number and expiry on receipts
Payment mode for the credit	Sample approval certificates say the credit applies to donations made through crossed cheques (example)	Ask FBR or a tax lawyer whether wallet and card payments qualify before advertising "tax-deductible"
Zakat tax treatment	Only statutory Zakat qualifies for the Section 60 deduction; voluntary giving falls under Section 61 (source)	Do not call every donation "tax deductible"

Compliance and risk

Area	What to know	Action
AML / CFT	SECP issued anti-money-laundering guidelines for non-profits, based on FATF standards (source). Section 42 NGOs must keep registers of donors, donations and beneficiaries (source)	Keep KYC on NGOs and large donors, keep records, and report suspicious activity as advised by your lawyer
NGO registration rules are changing	SECP proposed that Section 42 companies register with provincial Charities Commissions and that larger ones renew PCP certification every 3 years (source)	Re-check the rules at launch; store certificate expiry dates

Area	What to know	Action
Data protection	The Personal Data Protection Bill 2023 is described by legal commentary as still pending, not an enacted Act (source); a PKCERT advisory on handling personal data was issued in August 2025 (source)	Write your privacy policy to the Bill's standard anyway; collect minimum data; get consent
CSR law	The CSR Bill 2026 passed the National Assembly in January 2026 and then needed Senate and presidential approval (source); it requires disclosure and makes CSR spending deductible (source)	Confirm whether it is now law before calling it "enacted"
Zakat and general funds	Zakat has special rules	Keep Zakat in a separate ledger and account; never mix with fees or general funds
Foreign donations	Heavily regulated and sensitive for FATF reasons	Exclude in Phase 1
Public fundraising rules	Provinces have charity and fundraising rules	Ask a lawyer what applies to an online platform
Platform documents	Users must agree to them	Terms of Use, Privacy Policy, Refund and Dispute Policy, NGO Agreement, Complaint process
Receipts	Receipts must carry the NGO's name, approval details, amount, date and transaction reference	Generate on the NGO's behalf only with its consent

Always-on habits: keep an audit trail of every donation and admin action, separate accounts for Zakat, general donations and your own income, written NGO agreements, and a way for donors to report fraud.

8. Pros, cons and SWOT

The idea is strong on need and timing, but it lives or dies on trust, NGO onboarding and compliance, not on features.

Pros	Cons
Very large giving culture, and digital payments are growing	Trust is hard to earn: one fraud case can end the brand
No platform unites many NGOs, local wallets, Zakat tools and Urdu	NGO onboarding is slow, and verification takes real staff time
Fee-on-success model needs no upfront payment from NGOs	Thin margins after gateway fees
Data and analytics are a real NGO benefit	Compliance (AML, tax, charity laws) is heavy for a small team
CSR demand may grow	Holding funds needs a licensed partner
Strong academic project with real-world use	AI running costs and wallet API limits (recurring payments) may bite

SWOT	Points
Strengths	Local features (Zakat, Sadqa Jariya, Urdu), multi-NGO, analytics, verified listing
Weaknesses	Student team, no brand or donor base yet, no payment licence, single developer for each area
Opportunities	CSR Bill, rising mobile payments, Ramadan and emergency seasons, NGOs wanting data tools
Threats	Established names (Alkhidmat, Edhi, JazzCash/Easypaisa charity modules), regulation changes, fraud or negative news, donor distrust

9. Risks, launch roadmap and FYP evaluation plan

The biggest risks are a fake NGO getting listed and money being mishandled, so those get the strongest controls.

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Fake or misused NGO	High	Manual verification, expiry tracking, hold rules, fast suspension, donor reporting
Money laundering / terror financing	High	KYC, proscribed-list screening, large-donation holds, records, no foreign money in Phase 1
Payment API limits	Medium	Test in sandbox early; confirm recurring-payment support; fallback to reminders
Low NGO sign-ups	High	Free tier, pilot with 5-10 trusted NGOs, personal onboarding
Donor data leak	High	Minimum data, encryption in transit and at rest, access control, no personal data sent to OpenAI
Wrong AI output	Medium	NGO reviews impact stories before publishing; chatbot answers only from platform data and says when unsure
Religious complaint about fees on Zakat	Medium	0% on Zakat, Shariah board opinion
Cost overrun (AI, hosting)	Medium	Usage caps, cheaper models, monitor monthly spend

Launch roadmap

Phase	Goal	Gate to move on
0. FYP	Working demo in sandbox: verification, donation, hold, receipt, dashboard	Evaluation passed
1. Pilot	5-10 verified NGOs, real merchant account, free tier, 5% fee	Legal structure ready; Zakat opinion obtained; no major incident

Phase	Goal	Gate to move on
2. Grow	NGO Pro plan, recurring giving, featured slots	Steady monthly donations and NGO retention
3. Scale	CSR packages, Inaayat Plus, more cities	Break-even reached; compliance audit done

What to show at evaluation (MVP)

1. NGO signs up, uploads documents, admin verifies it and sets an expiry.
2. Donor browses, donates in sandbox, gets a receipt.
3. A large donation goes On hold, admin releases it, both sides see the status.
4. Fee calculation shown on the screen (5% general, 0% Zakat).
5. Zakat calculator linked to donating.
6. NGO dashboard with real-time totals.
7. One or two AI features done well (chatbot and impact story), the rest shown as planned.

10. Gaps in the proposal to fix before evaluation

Eight statements in the proposal could be challenged by a supervisor or examiner. Fix the wording now.

#	In the proposal	Issue	Suggested fix
1	"Personal Data Protection Act 2023"	Public commentary still calls it a Bill awaiting enactment (source)	Write "Personal Data Protection Bill 2023 (draft) and PKCERT guidance"
2	"CSR Bill 2026 … makes charitable expenditure tax deductible"	Passed the National Assembly in January 2026; Senate and presidential approval were pending then (source)	Say "passed by the National Assembly"; confirm current status

#	In the proposal	Issue	Suggested fix
3	"Receipts compliant with FBR Section 61"	Section 61 is the donor's tax credit, tied to the NGO's Section 2(36) approval; sample certificates mention crossed-cheque donations	Say "receipts showing the NGO's approval details"; verify wallet payments qualify
4	"Only FBR and PCP certified NGOs"	PCP certification is voluntary; many genuine NGOs have FBR approval but not PCP	Require registration plus FBR Section 2(36) approval; treat PCP as an extra trust badge
5	Architecture: figure shows microservices and an API gateway; text describes one Node/Express server; Admin Panel appears in the figure only	Inconsistent	Pick one and make text and figure match; for the FYP, a modular monolith is realistic
6	"Recurring donations through JazzCash/Easypaisa"	Standard merchant APIs may not support automatic wallet debits	Confirm in the gateways' documentation; otherwise use reminders with one-tap pay
7	"Seven AI features" and "end-to-end encryption"	Suspicious-activity monitoring is rule-based, predictive analysis is mostly statistics, and end-to-end encryption is unusual for payments	Call them "AI-assisted and rule-based"; say "TLS in transit, encryption at rest"
8	Literature review cites Ahmad et al. (2022) and Bhatt and Kumar (2023)	Neither appears in the References list; reference [1] is from 2016	Add full references, or remove the claims

Two more points: do not send donors' personal data to OpenAI (use anonymised IDs), and the proposal says suspicious transactions are flagged "before funds are credited", so define exactly how funds are held (Section 5).

Sources (search-result excerpts, open them to verify): FAFEN on CSR Bill, Business Recorder, PCP Section 61 guide, DataGuidance, Absco, SECP AML guidelines, SECP NPO regulations, SECP proposals, Section 61 summary.